



Module: Introduction to Social Research

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Introduction

This piece of work is in two parts. The first section offers a critical review of the main aspects of social research covered in the Introduction to Social Research module. It discusses the philosophical grounds on which different approaches to social research develop and describes the various stages and methods that are accounted for in literature on social research theory. The second section presents a proposal for a small-scale research project for a Masters Degree's dissertation in Development Education at the IOE.

Critical Review

Approaches to social research: qualitative, quantitative or mixed-method?

Social research is concerned with advancing knowledge scientifically in the various fields of the social world. However, there have been longstanding debates over the very nature of social reality, the scientificity of social sciences and the appropriate methods to generate reliable knowledge in this field.

Philosophical assumptions as to what constitutes the nature of reality – ontology – determine the ways it can be investigated, and the conditions under which it can constitute an object of knowledge: epistemology (Neuman, 2014; Cohen et al., 2011; Denscombe, 2010). For realist ontology reality exists objectively, absolutely and independently of our beliefs about it, while nominalism holds that reality is produced by people's perceptions and only exists insofar as they create it through their actions, beliefs and symbolic representations. Neuman (2014) notes that these views represent extreme poles on a continuum that allows for 'critical realists' or 'moderate nominalists' to take nuanced stances.

As regards epistemology, positivism, grounded in realist ontology, believes that reality is observable empirically and is the same regardless of who observes it. Knowledge about reality is therefore objective and value-free. Interpretivism, underpinned by nominalism, conversely considers that knowledge about social reality is acquired through understanding of people's subjectivity, and is necessarily value-laden.

Positivism finds its roots in the Enlightenment idea that Truth can be discovered by the use of Reason (Neuman, 2014) and is fundamental to the development of natural sciences in the 18th century. Positivism was the paradigm within which early social science developed, although later schools of sociology, interpretivist in their approach, challenged its philosophical assumptions.

Debates go on over the reliability and legitimacy of the methods used by the researchers who adapt to social sciences the approach pertaining to natural sciences on the one hand, and interpretivists (or constructivists) on the other. For the former, knowledge is based on empirical observations, experiments, measurements and deductive reasoning, while the latter base knowledge on interpretation of meaning attributed by people to their own experience and within an inductive approach. Positivism has a determinist view on human nature – people's behaviour is determined by their environment – and knowledge seeks to establish causal laws that explain this behaviour while interpretivists have a voluntarist view and therefore seek to better understand subjective motives for behaviour.

Consequently, the positivist approach tends to use methods of inquiry that produce data in the form of numbers – quantitative methods – while interpretivists will use methods that produce qualitative data: data in the form of language (stories, interviews, diaries, autobiographies, etc.) (Neuman, 2014). Quantitative research has been critiqued for generating knowledge in order to control, govern and dominate society (Foucault, 2001), while qualitative approaches have been accused of having abandoned scientific methods of verification (Cohen et al., 2011).

Becoming increasingly popular (Robson, 2011), is an approach to social science that makes use of both qualitative and quantitative strategies. Referred to as the realist approach (although distinct from ontological realism), it draws on a pragmatic stance (Creswell, 2014; Robson, 2011) which rejects dualisms. The view that justifies the use of a mixed approach and overcomes an apparent contradiction is that reality is constituted of various layers. Some of these layers concern the individual in her subjective reality and might be best studied qualitatively, while others concern overarching social structures that might lend themselves to a more deterministic and nomothetic approach. In this perspective, research commits itself to understanding the dynamic interactions of “interwoven” levels of reality which Layder refers to as “micro” and ‘macro’ levels (1993, p.8).

One particular trend of the realist approach, the critical realist, asserts a “transformative worldview” (Creswell, 2014). It criticises both positivism and interpretivism: the former for being “narrow, antidemocratic and nonhumanist” (Neuman, 2014, p. 110), and the latter for being too relativist with regard to values and for not taking a moral position towards social justice. For critical realists, the purpose of research is not only to understand social reality but also to change it by “revealing the underlying sources of social control, power relations, and inequalities” (*ibid.* p. 111). Such schools include researchers involved in feminist emancipation, queer studies or postcolonial studies (Creswell, 2014), and add to the ongoing debate about the nature and the scope of social science. Roseneil and Frosh (2012) note the significance of the “cultural turn” (p. 2) in extending the field of the “social” to the “cultural” world, owing to the influence of poststructuralism, and Narayan (2012) highlights the role of postcolonial studies in producing “paradigmatic shifts” (p. 144) in academic fields pertaining to social science.

Conceptual framework

Our perception of phenomena is necessarily framed within theories, although possibly tacit theories built as ways of “reducing ambiguity and explaining paradox” (Marshall and Rossman, 1995. p. 19). While researchers may begin with an “interesting, curious or anomalous” phenomenon they “discover or stumble across” (p. 16) as part of their professional experience, in relation to empirical research, gaps in explanatory theories or from their personal experience, they must, in order to conduct their inquiry, adopt a systematic approach and raise the problematic issue to a more general level of existing formal theories (*ibid.*). The conceptual framework provides the theoretical context in which the phenomenon can be formulated.

Literature review

Developing the conceptual framework and situating the research project within existing academic research involves engaging with existing literature. The literature review also allows researchers to learn about research methods (Blaxter et al., 2006) and how they can be applied, and to identify areas that have not yet been researched and that they might address (*ibid.*). Reviewing the literature needs to be a recurrent process in the context of extended projects, as researchers must ‘keep up’ with new research and findings in their

field. Additionally, increasing electronic publication and online libraries make it necessary to familiarise with search engines and tools such as Boolean operators.

Research question

“A research question encapsulates what the researcher is trying to find out and provides the direction and shape for the research” (Hammond and Wellington, 2013, p. 128). Questions are framed within ontological and epistemological assumptions and therefore determine the way they can be answered: the methodology, which “must deliver the data to address the question” (*ibid.*). Robson (2011) notes that research questions can usefully provide “the key to planning and carrying out” a project (p. 58), and particularly apply to researchers working with flexible designs although they are not a *sine qua non*. Indeed, researchers conducting experiments within fixed designs may rely on their hypotheses to guide the research procedure (Warwick, 2014).

Research Design

Robson (2011) describes research design as the architecture of a research project. It is the conceptual structure that ensures the purpose(s) of the research, the research question(s), the theoretical framework and the methods for collecting and analysing the data are coherently interrelated. The design addresses key questions (Denscombe, 2010) relating to time – whether a situation is studied at a given point in time (cross-sectional) or as it evolves over time (longitudinal) – to the number of cases to study – a large number, or only one but in a great deal of depth (case study) – as well as to theory – will the study generate or test existing theories?

Bryman (2012) identifies five types of design (experimental, cross-sectional, longitudinal, case study and comparative) while Creswell (2014) classifies them according to their approach: quantitative, qualitative and mixed methods designs. Robson (2011), similarly, sees design types as falling into three categories, fixed, flexible and multi-strategy design.

Fixed designs feature pre-specified procedures dictated by pre-existing theories the study will test, are almost always quantitative in their approach (Robson, 2011) and experimental in nature, i.e. a degree of control of the environment makes the manipulation of identified variables possible. Conversely, flexible designs tend to be theory generating, qualitative, and allow for elements of the design to evolve as the project unfolds. Case studies, ethnographic studies and grounded theory studies are typically designed according to a flexible approach (*ibid.*). The increasingly widespread realist approach however, makes use of designs – referred to as mixed methods or multi-strategy designs – that feature elements of both strategies.

Research methods

Methodology refers to the philosophical paradigms underpinning the research (qualitative or quantitative approaches) while the term methods usually refers to the tools of data collection and analysis (Blaxter et al. 2006; Hammond and Wellington, 2013; Bryman,

2012). Research methods include surveys, observations and interviews, but also analytic tools such as content analysis or discourse analysis (Hammond and Wellington, 2013). While surveys are more typically associated with fixed designs and a quantitative approach (Bryman, 2012), observations or interviews can be conducted within either paradigm, have different underlying purposes and produce broadly different data (Blaxter et al.). Observations, for example, can be highly structured and look out for elements identified before hand in the context of a fixed design, or be semi-structured (unstructured) and unsystematic as the researcher may not have yet determined what constitutes evidence and what exactly to observe (Cohen et al., 2011). In the same way, interviews can be variably structured and feature standardised questions or “questions that emerge from the immediate context” (*Ibid.* p. 413).

Trustworthiness

The value of research – its capacity to advance knowledge and to be recognized as useful – relies on criteria shared by the scientific community. These criteria find their origin in hard sciences and are mostly concerned with the quality of the measurements, the relevance of what is being measured to the conclusions that are drawn and the soundness of identified causal relationships (Bryman, 2012); they are identified as reliability, validity and replicability. The divide between exponents of the positivist and the constructionist approaches is here also evident. While Hancké (2006) for example, transposes these criteria from hard sciences to the social sciences and advises researchers to “avoid having to rely on interview data alone” because of validity concerns (p. 104), other theorists propose a set of criteria more appropriate to the evaluation of qualitative research. They propose the concept of trustworthiness which comprises the notions of transferability, credibility, dependability and confirmability (Bryman, 2012; Robson, 2011). While credibility and dependability parallel the notions of validity and reliability (Bryman, 2012), confirmability parallels that of objectivity and concerns issues of bias – the extent to which the researcher has allowed her values to intrude – and transferability that of generalizability, i.e. the extent to which findings are useful and relevant if transposed to a different or wider context. The latter notion is significantly linked to the technique used to select participants or cases to investigate, i.e. sampling.

Sampling methods

Sampling refers to the strategy used to identify and choose cases (individuals, institutions, events, etc.) to study. Theory literature classifies sampling strategies according to two broad categories: probability and non-probability sampling (Mertens, 2010; Bryman, 2012; Neuman, 2014; Robson, 2011; Blaxter et al., 2006). Researchers for whom generalizability is of primary importance will focus on the representativeness of the cases and use probability sampling and mathematical theory to calculate the relationship between their sample and the wider population so as to extrapolate their conclusions with a degree of confidence. On the other hand, researchers who seek to focus on the in-depth understanding of a limited amount of cases, for example, may not judge generalizability rele-

vant and use non-probability sampling strategies. A wide array of techniques have been developed within both approaches to address the complexity of social reality; some populations, for example, may be difficult to reach, or the topic of certain projects may necessitate a great deal of trust between the participant and the researcher and restrict the possibilities of the researcher. Whichever approach the researcher chooses, she must carefully consider the techniques to be used and justify them in relation to the purpose of the research.

Ethical issues

Ethics debates in social research seek to resolve the tension between two sets of values, as described by Aronson and Carlsmith (1969; cited in Cohen et al., 2011). One is that of democracy, human dignity and freedom, the other of “free scientific inquiry in pursuit of truth and knowledge” (p. 85). A number of organisations (Bell, 2005) have now formalised codes of conduct and guidelines which address ethical issues such as deception of participants, participants’ rights to privacy, care needed when involving children or vulnerable individuals, and more. A “cornerstone” notion (Cohen et al., 2011, p. 77) that has been developed is that of ‘informed consent’. It is the process of getting from a participant their agreement to take part in a study while fully informing them of the purpose of the project, the potential risk they may be exposed to, and their rights, e.g. right to withdraw from the project, right to confidentiality, etc. This notion is not always straightforward when, for example, awareness of the purpose of the research may alter the behaviour to be observed or when working with people who may not always be able to express their consent in an autonomous way – researchers need to find suitable ways to ensure participants understand what they commit themselves to and guarantee their rights and wellbeing. The debate whether ethical regulations have resulted in better quality data owing to more trusting and equal relationships between researchers and participants, or in poorer data as a result of informed consent processes restricting researchers’ possibilities is ongoing (Robson, 2011).

Data analysis

Once data are collected they must be analysed and interpreted in order to seek explanation and understanding. Although there is a divide between qualitative data (interviews, documents, observation notes, etc.) and quantitative data (measurements, categories, percentages, etc.), Blaxter et al. (2006) note that qualitative data may be quantified in the process of codification and quantitative data qualified in the process of interpretation. The authors insist that neither are facts and that they only ‘offer what we as individuals perceive of as our ‘reality’.’ (p. 199)

Descriptive statistics is used to describe sets of information in numeric forms with measurements of central tendency (mean, median and mode) and of variability (range, mean variation, or standard deviation) (Robson, 2011). However, Robson (*ibid.*, p. 427), citing Marsh and Elliott (2008, p. 57) points out that “data are produced, not given”; the data collected are the result of the researchers’ choices as to what constitute evidence.

Blaxter et al. (2006) also note that the seeming precision of numbers may hide their “manufacture, imprecision and subjectivity” (2006, p. 200). The way data are presented is also the result of choices; choosing one measurement of central tendency over another may give a different perspective on a data set and be used to support one particular interpretation.

Analysing qualitative data consists in identifying sets of key themes and to explore their relationships (Laws et al., 2003). These themes may emerge from the material itself and/or from the research questions and the researcher’s “theory about what is going on” (*ibid.* p. 396). Blaxter et al. (2006) warn about a major difficulty in analysing texts and speeches: documents are published after drafting and re-drafting while speeches, even direct speeches, may be equally as selective. Thus, meaning is to be found in what is said but also in what is not said and in how it is said.

Both approaches require different sets of skills, however, both require the researcher to take a critical distance with the data and with their interpretations, i.e. to be reflexive (Wellington and Szczerbinski, 2007).

Conclusion

Wellington and Szczerbinski (*ibid.*) note that social research is a ‘messy business’, and the different “stages involved [...] do not simply follow one after the other” (Baxter et al., 2006, p. 193), furthermore, this ‘messiness’ is not necessarily reflected in the linearity of research reports (Hammond and Wellington, 2013).

The complexity and diversity of human nature and human societies is also mirrored in the conflicting views and interests that unavoidably ground and are involved in the building of knowledge (Foucault, 1975) – of plural knowledge. Throughout this section I have reviewed the main aspects of social research and outlined the questions in debate among the different approaches; in the following I will present my proposal for a small-scale research project.

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Global citizenship in UK Higher Education: Perceptions of international students at De Montfort University, Leicester – proposal for a small-scale study.

Background

In recent years, Western countries and in particular the UK, have placed a strong focus on recruiting Higher education (HE) international students. In 2012 – 2013 non-EU students made up around 13% of the UK students total population and according to the OECD, the following English speaking countries, the USA, UK, Australia and Canada combined, received 40% of the students enrolled outside their country of citizenship (Universities UK, 2014).

Internationalisation of HE is defined by Killick (2015) as a response to the various transformations of the world that make up globalisation, but also notes that some of its aspects contribute to globalisation. This situation raises issues as to the role of HE. One concerns its role in preparing people to live in a world where cultures and peoples are increasingly interdependent and exposed to one another, in a world of social and political uncertainty where issues of peace, solidarity, democracy and environment need addressing in a context of reconfiguration of national agency, international cooperation and global governance. Another issue relates to the role the English language plays, as it is becoming/has become the leading language of globalisation, in transforming international students' relationships and sense of belonging to their communities whether cultural, linguistic, regional, national or global.

The aim of this study is to understand international students' perceptions of global citizenship and their expectations towards their studies in the UK in this regard. Furthermore, it will consider the ways in which studying in English might contribute to the formation of a global citizen.

Conceptual framework

The study will be guided by the values and purposes of Development Education and Global Learning, whereby education, in an increasingly interconnected world society, is committed to developing a global outlook and an appreciation of the Other's perspective, is "supportive to a sense of social justice and solidarity" (Bourn, 2014, p. 140) and "develop[s] students who are *alert* to their own and others' entanglement in issues of (global) social justice" (Killick, 2015, p. 16, italics in original).

The concept of *internationalisation* of Higher Education will be understood and discussed within the terms of the debate described by Lunn (2006, p. 21), where mere internationalisation consists only in recruiting international students whilst 'true internationalisation' allows students to be "part of a genuinely integrated multicultural community", which must constitute the ground for the development of "global perspectives" and an adequate learning experience.

The concept of Global Citizenship will be framed within Andreotti's propositions for a critical citizenship education inspired by postcolonial literature and poststructuralism (Andreotti, 2011), and other connected concepts such as Osler's and Starkey's 'Cosmopolitan Citizenship' (2003) or Killick's 'Global Self' (2015).

Research questions

The study will be guided by the following research questions. The first one, however, will be answered through the literature review and the elaboration of the conceptual framework, so as to allow for the comparison of students' perceptions and expectations to the discourse of UK universities.

- How have globalisation and the internationalisation of Higher Education impacted upon the desired graduate attributes in UK universities?
- What are the perceptions of international students of the qualities and skills of a Global Citizen?
- What are the international students' expectations as to the place of their studies in the UK in becoming a global citizen?
- In what ways does studying in the English language alters international students' relationships and sense of belonging to a local/national/global community?
- What are the implications of the study's findings for curricular and extra-curricular activities in UK universities?

Research approach

The research will be critical realist in its approach. Its main purpose being to understand students' perceptions of their own involvement in the international student community and in the global society – which are likely to be influenced by their personal, social, national, linguistic or religious backgrounds – qualitative data collected by means of interviews are most appropriate.

The study will consider the various factors contributing (at various levels: micro – macro) to the formation of these different perspectives on global citizenship. Citizenship for instance, is a concept whose meaning changes from one political context to the other, and even from one social group to the other within the same political context. Furthermore, globalisation being a phenomenon that does not uniformly impact countries and peoples throughout the world (Stromquist and Monkman, 2000), social lives, cultural identities and people's relationships to the world are influenced by globalisation to various degrees and in different ways. It follows that Global Citizenship is an abstraction that will mobilise a broad range of representations and interpretations for different people.

The study will seek to faithfully describe these particular views, and my understanding of theory will serve to frame my own interpretation of the students' interpretations. The study will also aim at improving understanding of how differing perspectives might best be brought together in a learning environment to produce inclusive, empowering and ac-

tionable common concepts – i.e. how can a concept such as global citizenship be meaningful to everybody and what purpose could this serve?

Research design

The design of the project will be that of a “set of individual case studies” (Robson, 2011, p. 138) – i.e. the study will focus on a small number of cases, studied in their own rights. The commonality amongst the cases is that they will all be individuals, non-speakers of English as a native language, non-UK citizens and studying at De Montfort University. The study will be designed as flexible, early interviews are likely to inform the structure of later interviews and the ongoing literature review might alter the way data analysis is envisaged.

Research methods

Literature review

The literature review will consist in books and scholarly journals on various topics including:

- Development Education
- International Education
- Global/Cosmopolitan Citizenship and Global/Cosmopolitan Citizenship Education
- Internationalisation of the Higher Education sector in the UK
- Identity formation and second language learning
- Intercultural communication
- Identity issues in the context of the blurring of local/global boundaries.

The literature review will also include policy documents and university publications on the internationalisation of HE and the ‘global perspective’. A particular attention will be paid to studies that have been conducted in the past on the topic of global citizenship in various cultural contexts and various countries. This will aim to deepen my understanding of the issues at play and develop a rich theoretical framework that may refine the research questions, will inform the structure of the interviews and enrich the analysis of the data.

Another purpose of the literature review will be to study research projects that have adopted a similar research design, and to consider how qualitative data have been analysed.

Sampling

I have chosen to conduct this study at De Montfort University, Leicester (DMU). I teach English for Academic Purposes in the Centre for English Language Learning (CELL), which provides linguistic and academic support to international students. The trust relationship I built with the managers, teachers and students will allow for the collection of contextualised and meaningful data. With over 12% of its students coming from

130 countries (De Montfort University, 2015) the university is in the UK national average and constitutes an ideal terrain to investigate the matter I have chosen.

Given the small-scale nature of the project, a purposive sampling method will be used to identify and select participants to interviews and focus groups on the basis of their availability and willingness to take part in the project. In order to examine a broad range of perspectives the sample will seek to feature various nationality students studying in a variety of disciplines, undergraduate as well as postgraduates, and students who have been studying in an English speaking environment for various periods of time (including newly arrived students), it will also seek to feature an equal number of male and female students. In order to inform this sampling procedure, general (and anonymous) demographic information regarding these parameters will be obtained from the International Student Centre of the university.

To enable comparison and to consider the evolution of students' representations and expectations over time as they are immersed in an English-speaking international context, students from different cohorts will be recruited. Thus, in addition to individual interviews, two focus groups will be organised. One with students newly arrived from their country of origin and one with older students. It is expected that some participants to the focus groups will also agree to be interviewed as a second step so as to consider the possibility of their perceptions of global issues being influenced by intercultural interaction/discussion on these issues.

Data collection

The research primarily seeks to understand international students' perception of global citizenship within a constructionist approach, which justifies (Robson, 2011) the choice of interviews and focus groups as the primary approach of the study.

The interviews – I plan to conduct eight interviews – will be semi-structured, non-directive and will be piloted. They will be from 45 to 60 minutes in length, they will be tape recorded (with permission) and then transcribed for analysis. Notes will be taken about the conditions in which they have been conducted and about the quality of the interaction with the interviewee in order to assist reflection on the quality of the data and inform the analysis. It is worthwhile to note that the interviews will be conducted in English and that it is not the participants' first language. Issues of fluency and/or accuracy, especially with newly arrived students, may render the data difficult to analyse and used trustworthily. Piloting the interviews will be a critical aspect of the project, as it will prepare the interviewer for various ways to probe interviewees and have them paraphrase themselves, in order to reach as expressive a representation of their perceptions as possible.

The focus groups will be constituted of approximately 6 students each and will be led as group discussions. The researcher will act as a facilitator/observer and assist participants in eliciting one another's perceptions about global issues and global citizenship. The sessions will be videotaped if the participants agree to it. If no video or audio recording is possible, the researcher will then take as comprehensive notes as possible, focusing his attention on the observational aspect of his role. Note taking would then be guided

ed by an informal observational grid, and the attention of the observer by themes identified from the conceptual framework as well as from the unfolding situation. The focus groups will be opportunities to consider how common representations about global issues can be built among groups of students with various international backgrounds.

Data analysis

The data will be analysed according to a qualitative, thematic analysis approach. The recordings from the interviews will be transcribed. The focus groups, however, if video or audio taped might not lend themselves easily to full transcription as participants may sometimes speak at the same time, argue and interact in an animated manner. Thematic codes both emerging from the conceptual framework and from the data themselves will be identified and related to one another, and to theories, so as to allow meaning and interpretation.

Ethical review

The research will be conducted in compliance with the British Educational Research Association's Ethical Guidelines for Educational Research (BERA, 2011). Moreover, an ethics application will be submitted to the Institute of Education's Research Ethics Committee for approval prior to any data collection or attempt to contact potential participants.

Permission to conduct research

Formal permission to conduct research within the CELL and permission to mention the name of the organisation in my report will be sought from the director of the department and from the organisation's ethical committee – an application to gain ethical approval for research activities will also be submitted to DMU prior to the commencement of the investigation, as per DMU regulations.

Participants and recruitment

All participants to the study will be of age of majority. Some participants will be contacted through the CELL English classes; the researcher will visit classes, with permission from the Head of department and from the teachers concerned, and make short announcements informing potential volunteers of the aims of the study, the conditions of the interviews and focus groups and their rights as participants. Since not all international students of the university are enrolled in the linguistic support programme, and since the university cannot provide a visitor researcher with identity details about their students, some participants to the interviews may be recruited on the premises of the university, with due permission.

Informed consent

Consent from participants to the interviews and the focus groups will be sought both orally and in writing. Clear explanations – the participants' first language not being Eng-

lish understanding will be checked through conversation– will be given as to the aims of the project, the way and to whom it will be reported, and to the participants' rights not to answer all the questions, their right to withdraw from the study at any time should they wish to, as well as to the precautions taken by the researcher to ensure anonymity and confidentiality. A consent form re-stating the above points will then be submitted to the participants for approval and signature. Interview transcripts will be submitted to the interviewees in order to obtain their renewed consent to the researcher using them to document the report.

Privacy

Participants will only be referred to with codes in the transcripts, in the researcher's personal notes and in the report. Specific information that might link to any individual will not be disclosed nor made use of in the report. All personal data will be stored and processed in compliance with the Data Protection Act 1998. Electronic data will be stored encrypted and destroyed after completion of the project.

Possible issues

I am professionally involved as a teacher in the CELL. I will therefore ensure participants clearly understand that my research has no connection with their study programme and that they can participate (or refuse to) without any consequences for their studies. I will especially make clear that I will not judge them, or look for right or wrong answers or attitudes.

Should participants feel discomfort or embarrassment during the interview – and insofar as I am aware of these feelings – I may remind the participants that they do not have to answer all the questions. I will systematically debrief the interviewees, and remind them that they can choose to withdraw from the study.

Should I be revealed, in the course of an interview, information concerning other students or members of staff that I deem should be reported to a third party for ethical or security reasons, I may ask my supervisor for advice and assistance in appraising the situation, and make my decision in all conscience.

Reporting research findings

The research findings will be reported in the form of a 20 thousand-word dissertation for the IOE Development Education Masters Degree. A summary, in the form of an article, will be made available to the participants and to the members of the CELL. It is hoped that the findings of this research project will contribute to enhancing the international learning experience of present and future, international and domestic students in the university.

Time scale

The project will unfold over eleven months as follows:

Activity	Feb 15	Mar 15	Apr 15	May 15	Jun 15	Jul 15	Aug 15	Sep 15	Oct 15	Nov 15	Dec 15
Proposal outline											
Literature review											
Approval for the study											
Draft literature review chapter											
Draft methodology chapter											
Data collection											
Data analysis											
Draft remaining chapters											
Draft introduction and abstract											
Submit draft											
Finalizing dissertation											

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Appendices

Appendix I – Information leaflet for participants.

Appendix II – Consent form.

University College London Institute of Education

Global citizenship in UK Higher Education: Perceptions of international students at De Montfort University, Leicester

Research project

Information for [name participant]

Please will you help with my research?

My name is Stéphane Jacquet; I am a student at the Institute of education, London. This leaflet tells you about my research. I hope the leaflet will also be useful, and I would be pleased to answer any questions you have.

Why is this research being done?

The purpose of my research is to understand the various perspectives that international students in UK higher education may have on global citizenship.

Who will be in the project?

Eight international students will be interviewed and two focus groups (group interviews) of six students each will be conducted.

What questions will be asked? How long will the interview take?

You will be asked questions about your personal background (nationality, education) and about your views on global issues such as inter-cultural communication, global inequalities and environment. The interview will be about an hour long.

What will happen to you if you take part?

If you agree, I will tape record the interview and type it up later. I am not looking for right or wrong answers, only for what everyone really thinks.

Could there be problems for you if you take part?

I hope you will enjoy talking to me. Some people may feel upset when talking about some topics. If you want to stop talking, we will stop.

If you have any problems with the project, please tell me.

Will doing the research help you?

I hope you will enjoy helping me. The research will mainly collect ideas to help students and teachers in the future and help me learn to be a researcher so that I may do more research in the future, which will help other people.

Who will know that you have been in the research?

I will not tell anyone you are in the research nor what you tell me.

I will keep tapes and notes in a safe place, and will change all the names in my report so that no one knows who said what.

Do you have to take part?

You decide if you want to take part and, even if you say 'yes', you may decide not to answer some questions. You may also change your mind at any time until my report is submitted, and decide you do not want me to use what you have told me for my research.

You can tell me that you will take part by signing the consent form.

Will you know about the research results?

I will send you a short report by 01/03/2016.

The project has been reviewed by the Institute of Education Ethics Committee, [details].

Thank you for reading this leaflet.

Stéphane JACQUET

sjacquet@ioe.ac.uk
07933 835 250

CONSENT FORM

University College London

Institute of education

Global citizenship in UK Higher Education: Perceptions of international students at De Montfort University, Leicester

Name of researcher: Stéphane Jacquet

Please initial box

1. I confirm that I have read and understand the information sheet for the above study. I have had the opportunity to consider the information, ask questions and have had these answered satisfactorily.

☐

2. I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time, without giving any reason.

☐

3. I understand that any information given by me may be used in future reports, articles or presentations by the researcher.

☐

4. I understand that my name will not appear in any reports, articles or presentations.

☐

5. I agree to take part in the above study.

☐

Name of Participant

Date

Signature

Researcher

Date

Signature